

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

16th WEEK



NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL ... NO MORE !



Learning Space



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

18th APRIL, 2019

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How fire ravaged a French icon

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WILL BE REBUILT, WON'T BE THE SAME

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OURNAMENTAL TREASURES

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Fired By Passion

Built 850 years ago, Notre Dame cathedral can be rebuilt

When a man understands the art of seeing, he can trace the spirit of an age and the features of a king even in the knocker on a door, wrote Victor Hugo in *The Hunchback of Notre Dame*. That's a very tall order. But we all attempt it, at the Hampi complex, Sistine Chapel, Taj Mahal, Blue Mosque. . . . We are filled with wonder at our ancestors, at masterstrokes undefeated by time. The grief that is pouring in from across the world after Notre Dame cathedral's ravaging by fire is a measure of the awe it inspired among visitors – 12 million a year. Some felt divinity here, others a secular mystery, few were left unmoved.



If the world is feeling hurt that's nothing to France's agony. This is 'point zero' in the country to and from which all distances are measured. When the cathedral's spire fell to the flames, citizens said it seared their hearts. Even as the smell of smoke lessens the Paris skyline remains broken. This is where the coronation of Napoleon and the canonisation of Joan of Arc took place. Here a special mass celebrated the liberation from the Nazis and the bell named Emmanuel was rung to mark the tragedy of 9/11. This is where France came to cheer or to mourn. Where will the country turn to mourn the cathedral?

But Notre Dame may rise again to glory. In its 850 years' history it has seen desecration and reconstruction before. French President Emmanuel Macron has vowed to rebuild the "epicentre of our life". Some of the country's richest families are pledging hundreds of millions of euros for this effort. Citizens of other countries are telling their governments to help. Together there is a promise of resurrection.

UPSC CSE – GS I

GS I ... History, Heritage and Culture

History of the world will include events from 18th century such as industrial revolution, world wars, redrawing of national boundaries, colonization, decolonization, political philosophies like communism, capitalism, socialism etc. - their forms and effect on the society.



3 How fire ravaged French icon Notre Dame

Notre Dame is a religious landmark, and a national, cultural, historical emblem of France. The fire in the holiest week of Christianity has done 'colossal damage'. How did it happen, and what happens now?

WHEN AND HOW: Notre Dame was declared structurally sound after a preliminary inspection Tuesday, but the wood-and-lead roof and lacy spire, built of 750 tonnes of oak lined with lead, is gone. There are three huge holes in the vaulted ceiling, and a part of the vault has collapsed. The surface of the stone could have suffered due to being doused with cold water while very hot. A detailed assessment will take numerous tests, likely over many months.

COST OF RESTORATION: It is expected to be in the range of at least hundreds of millions of euros. The LVMH Group — which owns Louis Vuitton, Christian Dior and Givenchy — and its CEO Bernard Arnault, the third richest person in the world, pledged €200 million. François-Henri Pinault, CEO of the Kering Group which owns Gucci and Yves Saint Laurent, and oil and gas giant Total promised €100 million each. President Macron has said France will launch a global fundraising campaign, and European Council president Donald Tusk has appealed to EU member states to contribute.

EARLIER RENOVATIONS: This is probably the worst damage the cathedral has ever suffered. The present edifice was built after the original was destroyed by fire, and another fire led to more work between 1230 and 1240. Louis XIV and Louis XV remodelled it in the 17th and 18th centuries. In 1786, the original spire was replaced. The cathedral was damaged during the French Revolution, and there were overhauls from 1844 to 1864, when the spire and flying buttresses were re-done. In 2017, a €160 million renovation began, which was ongoing.

3 How fire ravaged French icon Notre Dame

WHAT'S LOST: Enough detailed information is available for France's highly developed restoration industry to produce a technically precise reconstruction. But it will never be the same cathedral again. Most of the chestnut and oak beams in the roof were originals from 800-900 years ago, from trees cut around 1160, when they were perhaps 300-400 years old. Such massive trees, and so much wood, is simply not available any longer. Also, the stone will be cut by machines rather than by hand.

HOW FIRE BEGAN AND SPREAD

Around 6.30 pm Paris time, smoke was seen on the roof near the scaffolding, and a fire was discovered in the attic — an oddly-located, rarely-visited space under the roof, nicknamed the 'forest' because of the dense network of massive wooden beams that crisscross it and are key to the building's structural integrity.

In less than an hour, the fire had spread outward from the area around the scaffolding (red ring) and climbed up the spire, a giant wood-frame needle covered in lead, about as tall as a 30-storey building. The spire collapsed and the fire kept spreading, burning through about two-thirds of the wooden roof before it could be put out around 11 pm. The two magnificent towers were saved.

WHY IT MATTERS

"Notre Dame of Paris is our history, the epicentre of our lives," President Emmanuel Macron said Monday. "It's the many books, the paintings, those that belong to all French men and French women, even those who have never come... We will rebuild it."

3 How fire ravaged French icon Notre Dame

The cathedral whose construction began in 1160 and which was consecrated nearly two centuries later in 1345, is arguably the greatest symbol of Paris, visited by 13 million people annually — nearly double the 7 million who visit Eiffel Tower.

The beloved landmark has been an inalienable part of the cultural history of France, inspiring the paintings of Marc Chagall, and immortalised in Victor Hugo's *The Hunchback of Notre Dame*.

It is the seat of the Archbishop of Paris; where England's Henry VI became, in 1431, the King of France; where Napoleon was crowned Emperor in 1804; where Joan of Arc was beatified in 1909. The great masterpiece of French Gothic architecture has survived, albeit not unscarred, the French Revolution, the Paris Commune of 1871, the two World Wars.

CROWN OF THORNS SAFE

SURVIVED: Notre Dame's most treasured relic, a band of rushes supposedly from the original crown of thorns placed on Jesus's head during his crucifixion (above); the 13th century Tunic of Saint Louis; at least one of the cathedral's immense stained glass windows.

FATE UNKNOWN: Numerous other works of art and statues, including the 8,000-pipe great organ, Nicolas Coustou's *Descent From the Cross* sculpture, and the purported fragment of the cross and a nail used in the crucifixion of Jesus.

3 Fired by passion

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But Notre Dame may rise again to glory. In its 850 years' history it has seen desecration and reconstruction before. French President Emmanuel Macron has vowed to rebuild the "epicentre of our life". Some of the country's richest families are pledging hundreds of millions of euros for this effort. Citizens of other countries are telling their governments to help. Together there is a promise of resurrection.

NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL ... NO MORE IN EXISTENCE!



CATHEDRAL

A very large, usually stone, building for Christian worship.

- 1 Notre Dame Cathedral, the iconic symbol of beauty and history of Paris was scarred by an extensive fire.
- 2 It caused its delicate spire (a tall, pointed structure on top of a building, especially on top of a church tower) to collapse.
- 3 It stunned thousands of onlookers, who gathered along the banks of Seine River.
- 4 Around 500 fire fighters battled the blaze for nearly five hours.

NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL ...

BEFORE



AFTER



This is point zero in the country of France, to and from which, all distances are measured. This is where the coronation of Napoleon in 1804 and canonization of Joan of Arc took place.

MORE ON NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL IN PARIS



- 1** Notre Dame Cathedral is the iconic symbol of beauty and history of Paris.
- 2** It is the jewel of medieval Gothic architecture built in 12th and 13th centuries.
- 3** The Cathedral is visited by about 30,000 people a day.
- 4** For centuries, France's kings and queens were married and buried here.

MORE ON NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL IN PARIS



EMMANUEL MACRON

PRESIDENT OF THE FRENCH REPUBLIC

5 The joyous thanksgiving ceremony after the Liberation of Paris in 1944 took place here.

6 It is built with heavy timber construction and soaring open spaces and lacks sophisticated fire protection systems and it resulted in the quick rise of flames.

French President Emmanuel Macron vowed to rebuild this monumental structure. Some of the Country's richest families are pledging hundreds of millions of euros for this effort.

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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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